Pupil studio resources & worksheet — Refining technique through structured critique

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 4 Part 1 · Big question: How do we use criteria-led critique to test material refinements and resolve our final identity outcome?

Arrival check

Why is a criteria-led critique ('Check the 5-value tonal range at the focal point') far more helpful than asking 'Do you like it?'

[ ] Criteria point directly to measurable studio mechanics — like tonal range, edge weight, and figure-ground separation

[ ] You can test the proposed fix on a small swatch card in two minutes before touching the final piece

[ ] Recording the critique -> swatch -> refinement chain provides top-band portfolio evidence

Starter visual cues

Criterion 1 (Figure-Ground balance): Does the central identity form command the frame over the background pattern?

Criterion 2 (Five-Value tonal Range): Are there deep darks, controlled mid-tones, and crisp highlights?

Criterion 3 (Edge & Line weight): Do varied contours separate near planes from far planes?

Protocol: Peer diagnostic -> 6 cm Live swatch Test -> Final artwork Resolution.

Vote: What should you do if a peer critique suggests adding a bold white gouache or pastel highlight rim, and you are unsure how it will react with your ink wash?

Studio practice planner

Lock in your criteria diagnostic, swatch test, and final resolution.

Shapes/Focus: Diagnostic: Boost figure-ground, Diagnostic: Widen 5-value range, Diagnostic: Varied contour weight, Diagnostic: Quiet background grid

Tools/Methods: Swatch: Translucent shadow glaze, Swatch: Opaque gouache/chalk rim, Swatch: Brush-pen edge lock, Swatch: Cross-contour hatch

Exit ticket

What is the quickest studio method to quieten a busy patterned background that is competing with your central focal point?

[ ] Apply a unifying translucent wash over the background or increase the tonal contrast and contour weight around the focal subject

[ ] Erase the central focal point

[ ] Fold the board in half